

Micro Mode

Micromax and modu tie-up to present the world's lightest 3.5G touch phone in India



Nokia C6 to hit India

Nokia to showcase new C6 phone in India by December 2010

Bazaar

SMC Ez StylePad

Resistance is futile!

They say the seven inch media tablet is the fast emerging sweet spot lying snugly between smartphone upgrades like the five inch Dell Streak and huge 10 inch iPad. The EZ StylePad is the newest entrant into this burgeoning market and SMC has chosen to launch starting with the Indian market.

It is built around a 720 MHz Cortex's ARM 11 processor which may not have the 1 GHz magic number, but is still a decent performer. It plays 720p video flawlessly with a wide range of file/codec support – a perfect media player than a browsing device. Whatever lag we noticed can be attributed to the resistive touch screen. Yup, that right it's a resistive screen.



So while Android 2.1 (with Marketplace) runs smoothly you will soon be resorting to using your fingernails and scrolling will still be a pain.

The back panel is glossy black and encloses two speakers – which incidentally are surprisingly loud. The right edge sports two rather interesting ports - USB 2.0 and HDMI 1.3C. The USB port can read FAT 32

flash drives and the Mini-HDMI port can stream 1080p content to an HD TV that is equivalent to any standalone HD media player. It clocked a battery life of 2.5 hours while playing video on the device.

Editor's Comment : The tablet is well laid out and is feature-packed. But I would rather spend \$100 more and buy the capacitive version.

Specifications

OS : Android 2.1
Processor : Cortex's ARM 11
RAM : 256MB
Memory: 32GB (SD card slot)
Connectivity : Wi-Fi 802.11b/g
Video out : mini-HDMI 1.3

Contact

SMC Networks India
Phone : +91-22-6741 9133
Email: sales@smc-india.com
Web site: www.smc-asia.com
Price: ₹15,990

6.5/10

Features.....7.5
Performance.....6.5
Build Quality.....6.0
Value for money.....6.0

Specifications

OS: OS X 10.6 (Snow Leopard)
CPU: Core 2 Duo P8800
RAM: 4 GB DDR3
GPU: NVIDIA GeForce 320M
HDD: 320 GB 5400 rpm
Resolution: 1280x800 pixels

Contact

Apple India

Phone: +91-80-41409000
Email: indiasales@mac.com
Web site: www.apple.com/in/buy/shop/
Price: ₹89,900

7.0/10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....6.5
Build Quality.....8.5
Value for money.....6.0

Apple MacBook Pro 13 inch

Almost the same...

Apple has provided their line of Mac Book Pros some much needed boost in juice with the introduction of Core i5 and i7 processors. While the exterior looks exactly the same (sorry to disappoint!), it's a step in the right direction giving the Core 2 Duos the boot.

Sadly for us though, the model we received was a Core 2 Duo version, reiterating the "nothing is new" tag. The CPU was a Core 2 Duo P8800 running at 2.66 GHz. Sheesh!

Another gripe we had is with the display quality. It



seems there is a drop in quality when compared to the 15-inch MacBook Pro that has a marked better display – not only is the contrast slightly better, colours

Unfortunately owing to the outdated processor, this Mac Book could not keep up with the same 15-inch Mac Book Pro

of the same generation. The GeForce 320M doesn't seem to be a solution for a casual gamer. Our tests show it to be no faster than the 9400M solution found on earlier models. At an MRP of ₹89,900, the latest Mac Book Pro 13 inch is not for everybody. But its a rugged, highly functional piece of equipment. Not exactly value for money, but one would need to think very hard to find an Apple product that is. Just try to skip the Core 2 Duo version if your budget permits it.